Example

Fight Plan: Alexander Volkanovski vs. Movsar Evloev**
UFC 333 – Featherweight Title – Oct 24, 2026

Strategy

Primary goal: **Keep the fight standing and force Evloev into a pure striking match.**

Volkanovski's path is built on elite distance management, feints, stance switches, and counter-striking. Evloev's entire undefeated UFC run (10-0, all decisions) is built on chain wrestling, body locks, trips, and top control. Neutralize the wrestling early and the fight tilts heavily toward Volkanovski.

Key tactical points:
- Use constant lateral movement, L-steps, and cross-steps to deny clean entries and cage pressure.
- Deploy the inside low kick + stance-switch counter (the same system that worked against Holloway, Ortega, and Lopes) to punish level changes.
- When Evloev shoots, sprawl, underhook, and immediately circle off or reverse. Do not accept prolonged bottom time.
- After stuffing or escaping, immediately re-engage with a stiff jab or low kick so Evloev pays for every failed attempt.
- Force Evloev to burn energy on chain wrestling. After 1–2 rounds of unsuccessful entries his arms and output should drop, opening cleaner striking windows.
- Avoid prolonged clinch battles against the fence. Break, reset, and re-establish range.
- In later rounds, increase volume and look for the finish once Evloev's wrestling threat is diminished. Volkanovski has publicly stated he believes no one in the division can beat him by decision and that Evloev's best path is a knockout—which he does not rate as likely.

Training Plan

Focus areas for the final camp (prioritized by impact):

1. **Anti-wrestling & get-ups (highest priority)**
- High-volume sprawl + underhook + circle drills vs chain wrestlers.
- Specific body-lock defense and trips (Evloev's signature).
- Butterfly guard sweeps and immediate stand-ups under pressure.
- Live rounds where the opponent is rewarded only for successful control time so Volkanovski practices escaping and scoring on the way up.

2. **Striking under wrestling threat**
- Feint-heavy sessions with a partner constantly threatening level changes.
- Stance-switch low-kick counters and jab entries while moving.
- Counter combinations when the opponent commits to a shot and is forced to reset.

3. **Conditioning for a 25-minute wrestling defense fight**
- Circuit work that mixes continuous movement, short sprawl bursts, and high-output striking.
- Emphasis on arm endurance (Evloev will force repeated clinch and grip battles).
- Simulate late-round scenarios where wrestling volume drops and pure striking volume increases.

4. **Cage craft and angle management**
- Drills specifically denying the fence (Evloev's preferred setup).
- Footwork ladders and lateral movement under pressure.

5. **Recovery & durability management**
- Given age (38) and recent KO history + pre-fight shoulder issue, prioritize mobility, soft-tissue work, and controlled sparring volume in the final weeks.

Weaknesses of Movsar Evloev

****Zero finishing threat in the UFC**:** All 10 UFC wins are decisions. No knockdowns or submission finishes inside the promotion. Power is functional but not fight-ending against elite competition.
****Striking is secondary and relatively unpolished****: Decent jab and body work that sets up entries, but prone to rushing range, wild spinning attempts (seen vs Murphy), and limited low-kick volume. Elite counter-strikers with good movement can out-point him at range.
****Highly predictable game plan**:** Once striking exchanges heat up or early takedowns are stuffed, he defaults to chain wrestling and pressure. Fighters with strong takedown defense and the ability to immediately punish failed shots can frustrate him.
****Limited ability to hold elite anti-wrestlers down****: He has high takedown volume and accuracy, but historically struggles to maintain prolonged dominant positions against high-level scramblers. Holding Volkanovski (who showed strong get-up ability even against Makhachev) for extended periods is his biggest question mark.
****Wear factors****: Recent virus/illness that forced a withdrawal, prior knee surgeries, and a broken nose before the Murphy fight. While he looked sharp in London, the

accumulated interruptions are a mild concern for a 5-round title fight against a high-pace veteran.
****Decision-only style can be outworked****: When forced into extended striking exchanges or when his control is interrupted, he has shown limited ability to out-volume or out-damage higher-level strikers over full fights.

Summary Approach

Stuff the wrestling early, make every failed entry costly with counters and low kicks, keep the fight in the open, and let Evloev's reliance on grappling become a liability as the fight lengthens. Volkanovski's movement, fight IQ, and proven ability to get back up make this a favorable stylistic matchup if the wrestling is neutralized.